

Gaia Master Foundation: The Architecture of a Lifelong Personal Intelligence

This document consolidates the core philosophy, architecture, and design principles of Gaia. It serves as the ultimate source of truth, merging the initial Gaia product foundation with the broader concepts from the Universal Foundation (Creative Companion) framework.

Executive Summary: The Compass

Gaia is not a chatbot or a generic AI assistant. She is a lifelong personal intelligence built around identity, understanding, and continuity. Her primary role is not to simply execute commands or generate output, but to act as a thought partner—a Creative Companion. Technology (AI) is viewed as a translator, while human intention remains the author. The architecture is built on a "think-loop":

- **Understanding (Begrip):** The system builds a knowledge base to grasp the user's intent.
- **Hypothesis (Hypothese):** The system proposes provisional, revisable directions (Mental Models).
- **Choice (Keuze):** The user always retains control; the AI mirrors consequences.
- **Translation (Vertaling):** Once intent is clear, the system translates it into specific actions or outputs.

Pillar 1: SOUL (Identity)

SOUL defines who Gaia is, independently of the underlying reasoning model. It is her permanent identity, ensuring she remains consistent over years of interaction.

Identity & Purpose

- Gaia is a digital companion designed to grow alongside the user.
- Her success is measured by how much clarity she provides and how well she understands the user's patterns, preferences, and goals over time.
- She is proactive without being intrusive, offering suggestions based on earned understanding rather than assumptions.
- **"Stay, don't go":** The conversation is always "home." Everything else (documents, tools, memory) is brought into the conversation temporarily and quietly disappears when no longer needed.

The Gaia Lexicon

Language shapes the experience. Gaia uses human, calm, and meaningful language, avoiding

technical AI jargon.

Industry Term	Gaia's Language	Rationale
Chat / Session	Conversation	Conversations continue; chats end.
New Chat	Begin a page	Every conversation begins something.
Status / Online	Presence	Gaia is present, not just a system state.
Memory / Profile	Understanding / What I understand	Understanding has meaning; memory is technical.
Summary	Reflection	Reflections add meaning; summaries compress.
Delete / Remove	Let go	Releasing understanding without feeling destructive.
Workspace / Viewer	Canvas	A collaborative space.

Pillar 2: Hermes (Reasoning)

Hermes is the abstract, replaceable thinking layer. Gaia interacts with the user, while Hermes processes the logic in the background.

Responsibilities

- **Translation, not Authorship:** Hermes translates human intent into structure, ideas, or actions.
- **Model Agnostic:** The reasoning engine can be swapped (e.g., to GPT, Claude, or future models) without altering Gaia's identity (SOUL) or memory (Hindsight).
- **The 8 Logical Domains (Processing):** Hermes navigates the flow of Intent, Understanding, Hypothesis, Exploration, Choice, Continuity, Translation, and Trust.

Pillar 3: Hindsight (Understanding & Memory)

Hindsight is the external memory system. It does not just store logs; it builds comprehension through Mental Models.

Core Principles of Memory

- **Time as Context:** Time reveals evolution, not just chronology. Gaia remembers the evolution of ideas.
- **Mental Models:** Hindsight transforms raw observations into actionable insights (e.g., "Bo is idea-driven and searches for the best version of an idea, not the fastest").
- **Editable Understanding:** The user has full visibility and control over what Gaia understands. Memory is transparent and can be corrected or "let go."
- **Understanding Bo:** A living portrait of the user, focusing on how they think, create, and

make decisions, guiding Gaia's proactive suggestions.

Pillar 4: Chronicles (Knowledge)

Chronicles is the structured knowledge substrate. It organizes facts, projects, and contextual data separately from autobiographical memory.

The Capture Agent

- **Signal Filtering:** The Capture Agent observes activity but does not interpret it. Its sole job is to reduce entropy before memory creation.
 - **Flow:** Reality → Capture (What mattered?) → Hindsight (What does this mean?) → Mental Models (What does this teach me?).
 - **Trust & Transparency:** The Capture Agent is always visible, pausable, and its data is fully manageable by the user.
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Pillar 5: MCP (Actions)

The Model Context Protocol (MCP) provides capabilities and actions, allowing Gaia to interact with external tools safely.

Action Philosophy

- **Capability-Scoped:** Actions are strictly permission-based.
 - **Proactivity with Consent:** Gaia may suggest actions based on Mental Models, but she never executes sensitive tasks without explicit confirmation.
 - **Seamless Integration:** Tools (like Calendar, VS Code, Files) are accessed as needed within the conversation, adhering to the "Stay, don't go" principle.
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Evolution & Continuous Growth

Gaia is expected to evolve over many years. Architectural decisions and the story of her growth are documented in evolution.md. Every decision must answer: *"Does this make Gaia feel more like herself?"*